ZACHARY KULOSZEWSKI

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Education

University of Chicago, Ph.D. Economics *2021–2027 (expected)*

Michigan State University, B.S. Economics, B.S. Statistics *2015–2019*

References

Professor Marianne Bertrand
University of Chicago
Booth School of Business
marianne.bertrand@chicagobooth.edu
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Professor Erin M. Kelley
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Harris School of Public Policy
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Professor Christina Brown
University of Chicago
Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
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Research and Teaching Fields

Primary: Development Economics, Labor Economics
Secondary: Energy and Environmental Economics, Behavioral Economics

Job Market Paper

The Labor Market between Firms: Labor Sharing in Urban Uganda

Abstract: *In low-income countries, firms face persistent challenges in hiring, such as costly skill verification and volatile demand. I document an informal solution in which firms in manufacturing clusters lend verified skilled workers to one another, a system I call "labor sharing." Using novel surveys of over 500 firms and 1,000 workers in Ugandan manufacturing, I find nearly 80% of surveyed firms participate, and that labor sharing provides state-contingent labor, allowing firms to flexibly meet demand shocks. Stated choice experiments show that firms value labor sharing at a 25% premium over other hiring channels, while workers value it similarly to other referrals. In an estimated hiring model with demand uncertainty and hidden worker skill, labor sharing increases total welfare by 7% relative to an economy without sharing, benefiting both firms and workers, and supports more, smaller firms. Sharing improves allocation within firms over time by smoothing demand shocks, but shifts permanent jobs to lower-productivity lending firms. In counterfactual policy experiments, I show that labor sharing determines which firms gain from skill policies. Certification further concentrates skilled permanent jobs among these lending firms, while training enables higher-productivity borrowing firms to expand their permanent workforce.*

Working Papers

What Limits Electricity Access? Experimental Evidence from an Informal Market (with Jun Wong)

Abstract: *Many households in developing countries are still unelectrified despite living near grid infrastructure. We propose a new explanation for this persistent challenge: a rigid, regulated price schedule that charges all households the same connection fee and marginal price. We document an informal market in urban Benin that offers the schedule the utility does not. Nearly half of electrified households buy electricity from neighbors who resell it, at a lower connection fee but a higher marginal price. To evaluate our explanation, we study this market by combining an RCT with an equilibrium model. We run an RCT with over 4,000 households, randomizing subsidies for connection fees and marginal prices to estimate demand and supply elasticities. Lower connection fees electrify households with lower electricity demand, and formal consumption subsidies expand informal supply. We use the experimental variation in connection fees and marginal prices to estimate an equilibrium model of electricity demand and supply. The model allows us to quantify the extent to which a menu of price schedules can expand electricity access. The informal market raises electrification rates by 29 percent while a utility menu with a low-fee option would raise electrification rates by 50 percent. These findings illustrate how a rigid price schedule can limit electricity access.*

Reallocation under Rationing: Evidence from Electricity Outages in South Africa (with Rowan Clarke, Christopher Eaglin, and Jun Wong)

Abstract: *Rationing policies are often designed with equity considerations in mind, yet whether equalizing exposure delivers equal economic impacts remains underexplored. We study electricity outages in South Africa, where rationing equalizes exposure across locations. Combining high frequency outage data with geocoded transactions from over 11,000 firms from 2021 to 2023, we show that equal exposure does not imply equal impact. Average sales remain unchanged, but outages induce reallocation: below-median firms lose roughly 11 percent of average revenue, while above-median firms gain 10 percent. We provide novel evidence that consumer substitution drives these effects and that advance notice amplifies disparities.*

The Long-Run Legacy of Temporary Incentives: Experimental Evidence from Childhood Immunization (with Anne Karing and Juliette Finetti)

Abstract: *We investigate the impact of incentives and their removal on parents' decisions to vaccinate subsequent children. We follow up with parents three years after exposure to a bracelet incentive for timely vaccination in Sierra Leone. Since only parents with a newborn at the time of the experiment were eligible for the incentive, we exploit within-clinic variation in exposure. First, we find that parents who received an incentive for an earlier child are 5 to 11% less likely to vaccinate their subsequent child on time compared to parents in the control group. There are no effects on vaccination rates by 15 months of age, suggesting that parents delay vaccination rather than abstaining altogether. Second, parents living in communities where incentives were implemented but who were ineligible for them exhibit no changes in vaccination behavior, ruling out changes in community norms or clinic as explanations. Third, incentives that were valued as signals of vaccination completion do not result in adverse effects after their removal. Our causal forest analysis suggests that parents with higher vaccination costs are most affected by these negative effects. Taken together, our findings suggest that experience of incentives can reduce parents' intrinsic motivation. These findings have important implications: while policy makers commonly focus on moving individuals to adopt a desirable behavior, we show that incentives may significantly impact the motivation of those already performing the desired action.*

Work in Progress

Job Seekers' Beliefs and Labor Market Demand (with Erin M. Kelley, Gregory Lane, Harry Moroz, Mohit Negi, and Evelyn Vezza) *Registered Report Conditionally Accepted, Journal of Development Economics*

Abstract: *Job seekers often face challenges in finding jobs that align with their skills and meet employer demands. To address this, we conduct a randomized controlled trial to evaluate whether artificial intelligence can assist job seekers in two key ways: 1) gaining a clearer understanding of their own skills, and 2) identifying careers that align with their skills and labor market demand. This improved understanding should enable job seekers to make more informed decisions about training programs and career paths, resulting in better labor market outcomes – such as securing jobs more quickly, staying employed longer, and achieving greater job satisfaction.*

Awards, Scholarships, and Grants

Becker Friedman Institute Development Economics Research Fund, $25,000	*2025*
Energy Policy Institute at the University of Chicago	*2025*
Lloyd & Susanne Rudolph Field Research Award, CISSR, $5,000	*2025*
Implementation Grant, J-PAL King Climate Action Initiative	*2025*
Implementation Grant, Weiss Fund for Development Economics, $25,000	*2025*
Pilot Grant, J-PAL King Climate Action Initiative, $22,760	*2024*
PhD Research Grant, CEPR-STEG, $19,000	*2024*
Small Research Grant, International Growth Centre, $33,000	*2024*
Pilot Grant, Weiss Fund for Development Economics, $14,445	*2023*
Pilot Grant, Weiss Fund for Development Economics, $15,000	*2023*
Proposal Development Grant, J-PAL King Climate Action Initiative, $9,090	*2023*
Exploratory Travel Grant, UChicago Development Economics Research Fund, $5,000	*2023*
Trustees' Award, awarded to the top graduating students at MSU	*2019*
Edward A. & Eleanor B. Carlin Award, for distinguished achievement in economics at MSU	*2018*

Teaching Experience

The University of Chicago

Elements of Economic Analysis I Honors (Undergraduate)	TA for Prof. Lima	*Fall 2025*
Behavioral Development Economics (Undergraduate)	TA for Prof. Karing	*Spring 2024*
Behavioral Development Economics (Ph.D.)	TA for Prof. Karing	*Spring 2024*
Behavioral Development Economics (Undergraduate)	TA for Prof. Karing	*Winter 2023*
Practicalities of Running Randomized Control Trials (Ph.D.)	TA for Prof. Glennerster	*Fall 2023*

Michigan State University

Introduction to Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)	TA for Prof. Goddeeris	*Fall 2018*
Introduction to Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)	TA for Prof. Amsler	*Fall 2017*

Research Experience and Other Employment

Research Consultant for the World Bank, Buenos Aires, Argentina	*2025*
Research Assistant for Prof. Rachel Glennerster, University of Chicago	*2023*
Research Assistant at the Development Innovation Lab, University of Chicago	*2022 – 2023*
Senior Research Analyst, Federal Reserve Bank of New York	*2019 – 2021*
Visiting Researcher, Economic Policy Research Institute, Cape Town	*2019*

Professional Experience

Organizer of Student Development Working Group, University of Chicago	*2022 – 2024*
Scientific Committee, Midwest International Development Economics Conference	*2024*

Conferences	*University of Cape Town, ERSA-SALDRU December Workshop*
Presentations	*International Growth Centre, UChicago Development Lunch Workshop*
Refereeing Activity	*Journal of Health Economics*

Other Writing

The labour market between firms: How sharing workers shapes hiring in Ugandan manufacturing, *The International Growth Centre*, Policy Brief

Economics of Informal Electricity Connections (with Jun Wong), *CEPR-STEG: Growth Research Program*, Policy Brief

Additional Information

Citizenship	USA
Programming Skills	R, Stata, LaTeX, Matlab, SAS
Languages	English (Native), Spanish (B2), French (A2)

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